Brand Identity Toolkit

Created by Column Five



Before you begin, make a copy of this template by selecting **FILE > MAKE A COPY.**

Welcome to Column Five's Brand Identity Toolkit.

Welcome to your ultimate brand identity toolkit. These templates, exercises, and checklists make it easy to design a beautiful brand identity that outshines your competition, connects with customers, and communicates who you really are. Before you dive in, read our Guide to Build a Brand Identity to get detailed step-by-step instructions to use these tools and build your brand the right way.

Table of Contents

1. Brand/Rebrand Audit Questionnaire Template ➔
2. Competitor Brand Audit Template ➔.
3. Brand Attributes Spectrum Exercise ➔
4. Branding Brief Template ➔
5. Visual Identity Checklist ➔

---

1. Brand/Rebrand Audit Questionnaire

Answer these questions to assess your current brand and craft a fresh brand identity that will support your goals. For more instructions, see our Guide to Do a Brand Audit.

Current Core Identity Audit

1. Organization name

List the way you want it on the logo, as well as any other derivatives.

Type here

2. What does your business do?

Use a succinct, objective description.

Fill in this statement:

Our [offering] is the only [category] that [benefit].

3. What is your Brand Heart?

List your purpose, vision, mission, and values.

Type here

4. Who is your audience?

Type here

5. Who is your competition?

List your 3-5 top competitors.

Type here

6. What are your key differentiators?

List the selling points that make you better than your competition.

Type here

7. What is your brand personality?

Type here

8. How are you currently perceived, and how do you want to be perceived?

Type here

Current Brand Personality

Place an **X** where your brand falls on the spectrum below.

Traditional	----------	Progressive
Exclusive	----------	Accessible
Corporate	----------	Friendly
Serious	----------	Fun, Playful
Understated	----------	Bold
Simple	----------	Complex
City/Urban	----------	Natural
Familiar	----------	Disruptive
Steady	----------	Dynamic
Realistic	----------	Idealistic

Current Verbal Identity Audit

1. What is your current tagline?	Type here
2. What is your current value prop?	Type here
3. What are your three main selling points/ messaging pillars?	Type here
4. What is your current brand personality?	Type here

5. What is your current brand voice/tone?

Type here

6. What works about your current verbal identity, and what needs to change?

Type here

Current Visual Identity Audit

1. What type of logo do you currently have?

See below for examples.

Type here



Logomark

A symbol or abstract representation of the brand (e.g., Nike's swoosh, McDonald's arches, etc.).

Column Five

Logotype

Stylized letters representing the brand's name (e.g., Coca-Cola, Dell, FedEx, NASA, etc.).



Combination mark

A logo that uses a combination of both words and symbols to represent the brand (e.g., AT&T, Domino's, etc.).

2. Does your logo work well across various mediums (print, web, social)?

Type here

3. Should your revised logo be "evolutionary" or "revolutionary"?

Decide whether you want to update your current logo or start from scratch.

Type here

4. Does your typography work well with your logo?

Type here

5. Does your color palette reflect your brand personality? .	Type here
6. Does your current visual identity align or misalign with your values?	Type here
7. Does your brand's imagery (illustrations, photography, etc.) reflect your personality and values?	Type here
8. Does your brand look different than your competition?	Type here
9. What works about your current visual identity, and what needs to change?	Type here

2. Competitor Brand Audit Template

Use this template to audit your competitors' brand identities and identify opportunities to differentiate your own identity. For more instructions, see our Guide to Do a Brand Audit.

	Brand 1:	Brand 2:	Brand 3:
1. Logo What shapes/imagery do they use? Do they use a word mark, logo mark, or both?			
2. Typography What dominant typefaces do they use (serif vs. sans serif)? What weights do they use (light, regular, bold)?			

3. Color palette What dominant colors do they use? Are they similar to other competitors?			
4, Photography Are they using stock photography or custom photography?			
5. Illustration What style do they use? Are humans depicted in their illustration style?			
6. Brand story Do you “get” their personality, positioning, etc. through their visual presentation?			
7. Copy What’s the tone (humorous, witty, serious, lighthearted)?			

	Brand 4:	Brand 5:
1. Logo What shapes/imagery do they use? Do they use a word mark, logo mark, or both?		

2. Typography What dominant typefaces do they use (serif vs. sans serif)? What weights do they use (light, regular, bold)?		
3. Color palette What dominant colors do they use? Are they similar to other competitors?		
4, Photography Are they using stock photography or custom photography?		
5. Illustration What style do they use? Are humans depicted in their illustration style?		
6. Brand story Do you “get” their personality, positioning, etc. through their visual presentation?		
7. Copy What’s the tone (humorous, witty, serious, lighthearted)?		

Key Takeaways

1. What common visual themes did you observe?	
2. What are your biggest opportunities to differentiate?	

---

3. Brand Attributes Exercise

Use this exercise to identify the core attributes you want your brand identity to communicate. For more guidance, see our Guide to Build a Brand Identity.

---

1. Gather your brand team.

It's best to do this with everyone in the same room (virtually or in person).

2. Use this template or copy this chart onto a whiteboard or shared document.

Have each participant add an X where they think your brand falls on each spectrum below. Note: Work off of one shared chart. It's especially helpful if each person uses a different color pen. This way you can "see" your groupthink. It will probably look something like this:

Traditional ----X----------XX----------X---X--------- Progressive

Traditional	—----------	Progressive
Exclusive	—----------	Accessible
Corporate	—----------	Friendly
Serious	—----------	Fun, Playful
Understated	—----------	Bold
Simple	—----------	Complex
City/Urban	—----------	Natural
Familiar	—----------	Disruptive
Steady	—----------	Dynamic

Realistic ---------- Idealistic

3. Distill your insights.

Talk through each spectrum, then choose 3-5 attributes that all of your stakeholders are strongly aligned with. If you don't like the exact words listed on the chart, choose the ones that best describe your brand. These will be the words you'll use to build your visual identity.

Attribute 1	
Attribute 2	
Attribute 3	
Attribute 4	
Attribute 5	

4. Branding Brief Template

Use this branding brief to communicate the key information your team needs to design a beautiful brand identity.

BRIEF TEMPLATE

Project Name

Overview

Goal

Success Metrics

Deliverables (logo, color, typography, etc.)

Key Stakeholders

Target Audience

Key Attributes to Convey

Key Messages

Budget

Timeline

Specs

Additional considerations (links to inspiration, reference images, etc.)

---

5. Visual Identity Checklist

Use this checklist to design an effective and comprehensive visual identity that communicates who you are. For more details on designing your brand, see our Guide to Build a Brand Identity.

Logo

Design a logo that reflects your brand personality.

- Ensure logo design works for web and print.
- Test that it renders well at small sizes.

Colors

Curate a simple but flexible palette.

- Choose 1 main color, 2 primary colors, 3-5 complementary colors, and 2 accent colors.

Typography

Select type that works as an extension of your logo.

- Identify a primary, secondary, and tertiary typeface.
- Consider mixing serif and sans serif.
- Test for legibility in print and on screen.

Hierarchy

Create a logical, intuitive system.

- Focus on guiding the viewer through the content easily.
- Include specifications for headers, subheaders, body copy, images, blurbs, etc.

Photography

Use consistent, cohesive visual styles.

- Ensure imagery is high quality and high resolution.
- Be mindful of inclusive representation.

Illustration

Use illustrations to visually enhance, not overwhelm.

- Choose a single style.
- Keep it simple.

Iconography

Focus on simplicity and clarity.

- Double-check that icons render clearly at small sizes.
- Make sure the image is relevant to the subject.

Data Visualization

Design for comprehension.

- Avoid clashing patterns. Use color instead.
- Don’t over-illustrate or use 3D charts.
- Order data intuitively (use alphabetically, ascending, or descending order).

Video & Motion Graphics

Keep branding consistent.

- Choose an animation style.
- Provide guidelines for kinetic text.

Web Design & Interactivity

Focus on creating the best user experience.

- Consider accessibility.
- Design for mobile.

Created by



Column Five is a world-class content marketing agency for companies that want to build winning brands, increase leads, and grow revenue. **Find out how we can help transform your marketing at columnfivemedia.com.**